

CASES WITH CBI

2006

Andhra Pradesh	7
Kerala	4
Maharashtra	3
Uttar Pradesh	2
Delhi	2

2007

Uttar Pradesh	20
Andhra Pradesh	2
Assam	2
Maharashtra	2
Kerala	1

2008*

Delhi	5
Uttar Pradesh	2
Haryana	2
Arunachal Pradesh	2
Tripura	1

* Till May 31



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over any case. They are referred to it either on the directives of a high court or the Supreme Court or by a state government under the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946. This is a process that may take days or years—the agency was asked to investigate the 1984 Delhi Sikh riots after 19 years. “Often, we find that the entire morphology of a crime scene has changed and there is very little evidence we can collect,” says a senior CBI officer. While investigating an 11-year-old case relating to the murder of a police constable in Shillong, CBI officials discovered a multi-storey building standing on the crime scene.

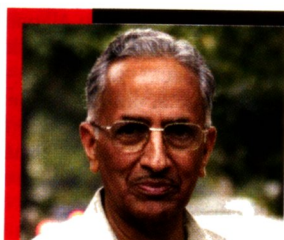
Even as the agency sleuths scout for clues in long trampled-over crime scene at the residence of Dr Rajesh

Talwar in Noida to look for evidence in the baffling twin murders of his 14-year-old daughter Aarushi and domestic help Hemraj, they could well wonder why routine police procedures were not followed in the initial hours of the crime scene. The reason? The Noida Police, which has now earned the dubious sobriquet of ‘No Idea’ police, was busy arranging security for the prime minister’s visit to ailing CPI(M) leader Harkishan Singh Surjeet. Noida, which is a bustling city, is yet to have a police commissionerate and still has to make do with a district police harking back to its days as a sleepy suburb.

“The district police are saddled with multiple responsibilities of providing VIP security and ensuring law and order,” says a senior CBI officer. Their

inability to deal with the complexities of rapid urbanisation or new challenges like terrorism is compounded by a lack of investment in the force by state governments and the systematic erosion of the powers of state police departments like the CID. Worse, a two-fold process of politicisation and neutralisation has defanged the police in several states.

The Uttar Pradesh Police’s Economic Offences Wing (EOW) runs with half its sanctioned strength and is struggling to probe a fertiliser scandal for the past 10 years. Its anti-corruption organisation cannot even investigate a case against a clerk without the state government’s permission. Its much-vaunted vigilance department and CID have become dumping grounds for upright officers. CBI officials say



“THE IMAGE OF THE POLICE IN SOME STATES IS AT SUCH AN ALL-TIME LOW THAT NOTHING SHORT OF CALLING IN CBI CAN INSPIRE PUBLIC CONFIDENCE.”

Prakash Singh, former DGP, Uttar Pradesh